INDIA GCC ECOSYSTEM · STRATEGY AND PRODUCT PROPOSAL · V2

GCC Ledger

The buyer’s side of the GCC market: evidence for the decision, built for the company entering India, not sold to the vendors chasing it.

Problem · Competitors · Opportunities · Solution · Positioning · Prototype

THE PROBLEM · THE DECISION

A large, rare, hard-to-reverse decision, made with the least neutral information

$4.3–4.9M

a year to run a 150-person BFSI centre across the metros, in our own planner model. **Illustrative.**

3–18 mo

to go live, across five workstreams (Wisemonk, 2026) and 8+ outside parties (our count).

~14%

cost spread between the big metros in our model (Chennai ₹25.3L vs Mumbai ₹28.9L per head).

The real cost of a bad call is not rent. It is a quarter of slow hiring, a failed EOR or BOT partner, or incentives left unclaimed. Each costs more than any advisory fee.

Cost figures: GCC Ledger prototype planner (illustrative assumptions, shown in the app). Timeline: Wisemonk GCC launch guide (2026).

THE PROBLEM · MARKET SIZE

$98B of activity, and nobody agrees on the basics

2,117

Zinnov–nasscom India GCC Landscape, FY26 (Mar 2026). Also counts 3,728 units.

1,760+

Zinnov blog, end of CY2025 (Jan 2026). Its FAQ counts 1,700+ in Tier I cities.

1,700+

Government, Lok Sabha reply (Aug 2025). PIB/MeitY repeats it citing nasscom (Dec 2025).

~1,700

Vestian (Jul 2025), about 53% of ~3,200 GCCs worldwide.

The count gap is a symptom. Most of it is definitions (companies, centres or units) and dates. The pain is that nobody tells the buyer which companies, which providers delivered, or what it will cost.

2.36M people and **$98.4B** revenue in FY26. Note: that is the GCCs' own revenue, not the market for our product (see sizing).

Sources: Zinnov–nasscom (2026); Zinnov (Jan 2026); Lok Sabha reply via IANS (Aug 2025); PIB/MeitY (Dec 2025); Vestian via PTI (Jul 2025)

THE PROBLEM · CITIES

Even the city leaderboard depends on whose report you read

City	GCCs (Vestian, Jul 2025)	Centres (Zinnov, Jan 2026)	Share of GCC leasing (CBRE)	Rent ₹/sq ft/mo (CRE Matrix)
Bengaluru	487	880+	~42%	132.6
Hyderabad	273	355+	~20%	76.8
Delhi-NCR	272	not published	~10–11%	102.9
Mumbai	207	not published	~4%	170.8
Pune	178	not published	~10–11%	90.2
Chennai	162	not published	~10–11%	83.3

Bengaluru has 487 GCCs, or 880+. A 1.8× gap for the most-studied city in India. Below the top six, almost nothing is published at all.

Sources: Vestian via PTI (Jul 2025); Zinnov (Jan 2026); CBRE, 2022 to H1 2026, via Entrepreneur India (Aug 2026); CRE Matrix Q1 CY26

THE PROBLEM · THE PLAYERS

Each player holds one piece, and most are paid by the outcome

Advisors and consultants
Benchmarks from past clients. Often also sell the setup.

Lawyers and auditors
Entity, FEMA, tax. See only their own clients.

Real estate firms
Leasing and rent data. Earn on the lease signed.

Recruiters
Salary and talent supply. Paid per hire.

The company entering India
Must assemble the truth from 8+ parties, once, with no prior experience.

EOR, payroll and BOT firms
Speed to first hire. Paid per employee or per build.

State governments
Incentives in long policy PDFs. Want to win the GCC.

Existing GCC leaders
Ground truth on who delivered. No channel to share it.

Talent
Pay and employer quality, scattered across job boards.

Typical setup runs 3 to 18 months across strategy, entity, infrastructure, hiring and go-live workstreams (Wisemonk setup guide, 2026)

THE PROBLEM · WHO IS HURT

The first-time entrant pays most, but nobody wins

Who	What the asymmetry costs them	Severity
First-time entrant	Picks city, model and partners on referral, then is locked in.	**Highest**
Small, capable providers	Win on marketing and referrals, not on delivery record.	**High**
State governments	10 states chase ~1,380 new GCCs by 2031, blind to who is evaluating.	**High**
Brokers and advisors	Rebuild the same lists every year, though they profit from the gap.	Medium
Talent	Cannot compare GCC employers on pay, growth or stability.	Medium

The core asymmetry: every new GCC is a multi-year bet, made by the one party with less information than every seller around it.

Sources: CBRE, The Policy Advantage, via Entrepreneur India (Aug 2026); Wisemonk setup timeline guide (2026)

THE PROBLEM · WHAT THEY DO TODAY

Today’s workarounds: every source is selling something or out of date

Referrals and peer calls

Works: trusted, fast and free.

Breaks: a sample of three, biased toward who you happen to know, and no numbers.

Consultant reports and advisory retainers

Works: deep benchmarks and hand-holding.

Breaks: costly, annual, figures disagree, and the advisor may also sell the setup.

Broker-led city tours

Works: a free, on-the-ground view of real space.

Breaks: paid on the lease signed, and the view stops at real estate.

Desk research: press, LinkedIn, state PDFs

Works: cheap and broad.

Breaks: weeks of work, undated, unverified and contradictory.

COMPETITORS · WHO ALREADY DOES THIS

Others already sell GCC data, mostly to the vendors

Product	What it does	Sells to	Gap for the entrant
GCC Explorer (AIM)	1,600–1,680+ named GCCs, daily updates; $3,500–10,000 a term	Mainly vendors selling to GCCs	No entry planning, incentives or provider evidence
OceanFrogs	1,600–2,100+ GCCs, decision-maker contacts, technology install base	Firms selling to GCCs	Knows who works with whom, not how well
GCC Index	New setups tracked weekly, cross-checked and confidence-scored	Free and paid tiers	Sees a GCC only once it is announced
Aokah	AI location scoring and a board-ready business case (launched Apr 2026)	Enterprises; partners with consultancies	Paid; claims unverified; no provider evidence
Draup	Scores 6,100+ locations worldwide on talent, cost and environment	Enterprises, by demo	Global and talent-led; no Indian incentives or setup path
ChatGPT, AI search	Instant, free answers to “where should we set up?”	Everyone	Blends conflicting figures; no verified or private evidence

COMPETITORS · SIDE BY SIDE (OUR READING)

Where we lose, break even, and win

Capability	GCC Explorer	OceanFrogs	Aokah	Draup	Setup firms	AI search	GCC Ledger
Named GCC list at scale	Yes	Yes	Unclear	Part	No	Part	**Goal**
City scoring and cost estimate	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Part	**Yes**
State incentives, clause by clause	No	No	Unclear	No	Part	Part	**Yes**
Free for the entrant	Part	No	No	No	Part	Yes	**Yes**
Earns nothing from your choice	Yes	Yes	Part	Yes	No	Yes	**Yes**
Shows why sources disagree	No	No	No	No	No	No	**Yes**
New GCCs spotted from filings	Part	Part	No	No	No	No	**Yes**
Client-confirmed delivery records	No	Part	No	No	No	No	**Yes**
Board pack that flags stale figures	No	No	Part	No	No	No	**Yes**

Neutrality alone is not unique: data companies earn nothing from your choice either. Our edge is the last four rows. On coverage, we lose today.

THE OPPORTUNITIES · OUR VIEW

Six opportunities: three kept, three folded in

Opportunity	Who pays	Already served by	Verdict
Entry decision intelligence	Entrant, team tier only	Aokah, Draup, setup firms	**Keep:** the wedge, won on neutrality and evidence
Verified delivery records	Providers, flat fee	Everest: 32 large firms, yearly	**Keep:** the moat, cannot be scraped
Early pipeline from filings	Brokers, recruiters, states	GCC Index, from announcements	**Keep:** aggregated data revenue
GCC directory	Nobody, it is free	GCC Explorer, OceanFrogs	**Fold in:** the free foundation
Talent and pay benchmarks	Nobody yet	Draup, staffing firms	**Fold in:** a planner input
Incentives and office space	Nobody yet	Brokers, state portals	**Fold in:** a planner input

THE OPPORTUNITIES · WHAT MATTERS MOST

Three opportunities matter most, in this order

1

THE WEDGE

Entry decision intelligence

Delivered as the Decision Room. Free to use, so the buyer trusts it; the team workspace is the paid tier.

2

THE MOAT

Verified delivery records

Delivery receipts confirmed by the client GCC. Every finished setup adds one, and nobody can scrape them.

3

THE REVENUE

Early pipeline from filings

New GCCs spotted from public filings before the press release, sold as counts and trends, never as contacts.

Changed from v1: the directory is now the free foundation, because incumbents already sell lists.

THE SOLUTION · GCC LEDGER

Every number carries its source, its date and how sure we are

HOW A FACT LOOKS IN THE LEDGER · GCCS IN INDIA

Figure	Source	As of	What it counts	Confidence
2,117	Zinnov–nasscom report	Mar 2026	Companies (3,728 units)	Reported
1,700+	Government, Lok Sabha reply	Aug 2025	Not stated	Reported
~1,700	Vestian	Jul 2025	Companies	Reported

Why they differ: different cut-off dates and definitions. We show all three instead of picking one, and link each to its source.

THE SOLUTION · WHAT NOBODY ELSE OFFERS

Three differentiators lead the product

1 · DECISION ROOM

A living, cited board pack

The plan becomes a one-page board memo. Every figure links to its source and date, and is flagged when that source changes. Advisors are invited to check their sections.

Others hand over a business case once. Nobody keeps each figure tied to its source.

2 · DELIVERY RECEIPTS

Facts, confirmed by the client

“Provider X set up the entity and hired the first 120 people for GCC Y in Pune.” It moves from Claimed to Verified when the client GCC confirms it. No star ratings.

Everest rates 32 large firms a year. Nobody confirms mid-size firms’ delivery.

3 · SIGNAL LADDER

New GCCs, before the press release

Rumoured, then entity incorporated (MCA), space approved (SEZ or STPI), lease, hiring, operational. Each step carries its document and date.

Trackers work from announcements. The filings are public, but nobody joins them.

THE SOLUTION · WHAT WE BUILD

Six modules on one source ledger, in demo order

01 · Differentiator

Decision Room

Cited board pack, stale-figure flags, comments from invited advisors.

02 · Differentiator

Delivery receipts

Provider records with client-confirmed delivery facts and a confirm form.

03 · Differentiator

Signals

New GCCs on the filings ladder: six real, two labelled illustrative.

04

Planner and city compare

Ranks cities, compares EOR, BOT and own entity, estimates cost.

05

GCC directory

Free foundation, with a deep source link and date on every record.

06

Ask the Ledger

Answers only from the Ledger’s data, citing a record for every claim.

Underneath: every fact stored with source, as-of date, what it counts, and a tier: Verified, Reported or Claimed.

THE SOLUTION · FOR WHOM FIRST

First user: the India-entry lead. Second: GCCs that are expanding.

WHO

VP Strategy or Head of India Entry at a mid-size global company, setting up its first GCC.

JOB TO BE DONE

Get a cited recommendation on city, model, cost and partners approved by the board.

SECOND SEGMENT

Existing GCCs opening a second city or scaling up. They come back.

110–165 new GCCs a year (TeamLease: 220 in FY23–25; UnearthIQ: 111 in eight months of 2026).

~40–60 of them mid-market a year, at the ~35% share nasscom–Zinnov reports. Our estimate.

2,117 existing GCCs that can expand: the repeat users (Zinnov–nasscom, FY26).

Entrants are the trust anchor, not the volume.

Sources: TeamLease via Storyboard18 (Nov 2025); UnearthIQ via NewsBytes (Sep 2026); nasscom–Zinnov (Apr 2025); Zinnov–nasscom FY26

THE SOLUTION · THE FIRST USER'S JOURNEY

From a blank page to a cited board recommendation

1 · Ask

"Where should a 150-person engineering and finance centre go?"

AI assistant

2 · Compare

Cities and states on rent, pay, talent and incentives.

City and state compare

3 · Plan

Operating model (EOR, BOT or captive) and annual run-rate cost.

Entry planner

4 · Shortlist

Partners with client-confirmed delivery receipts, not marketing.

Delivery receipts

5 · Decide

A cited board pack; lawyer, auditor and broker invited to check it.

Decision Room

Target outcome: a cited first draft of the recommendation in an afternoon instead of weeks. A hypothesis to test with design partners, not a measured result.

THE SOLUTION · THE DATA ENGINE

Built mostly from public data, joined and dated

Sources

- MCA filings and incorporations
- State GCC and IT policies
- Press releases, earnings calls
- Job postings by city and skill
- Leasing and rent reports
- Provider case studies
- GCC leader reviews (later)

Pipeline

1. Collect on a schedule
2. Extract facts with AI
3. Resolve parent, centre, unit
4. Cross-check across sources
5. Publish with date and tier
6. Take corrections, re-check

Confidence tiers

Verified: a filing, or two independent sources agree.

Reported: one credible published source.

Claimed: self-reported, for example by a provider about itself.

THE POSITIONING

The only GCC data built for the buyer, not sold to the vendors chasing it.

For companies deciding how to enter India: where every number comes from, which providers actually delivered, and what has changed since you decided.

Buyer-side

No contact lists, no lead fees, no rankings for sale.

Evidence

Sources, dates and client-confirmed delivery receipts.

Living

The board pack flags a figure when its source changes.

THE POSITIONING · EVERY PLAYER'S ROLE

One front door; every other player has a narrower one

Player	Role	Uses today	Why they come to GCC Ledger
Entrant, CFO, board	**Primary user**	Referrals, advisors, AI search	One cited board pack, free to start
GCC leaders	Contributor	Peer networks	Peer benchmarks; a say in provider reputation
Setup, EOR, BOT firms	Contributor, payer	Referrals, analyst ratings	Credit for proven delivery, flat fee
Lawyers, auditors	Invited guest	Email chains with the client	Seen by clients at the moment of choice
Brokers, recruiters	Guest, data payer	In-house research	Earlier, aggregated pipeline; no contacts
State governments	Contributor, payer	Roadshows, consultants	Why they win or lose; never city scores
Research firms	Cited source	Their own reports	Traffic and attribution, not competition
Talent	Later user	Job boards, review sites	Which GCCs are growing, and where

The invitation loop: each entrant invites its lawyer, auditor and broker into the Decision Room as guests, so the other players arrive through the buyer.

THE POSITIONING · HOW BIG

Who pays, how many, and what they pay others today

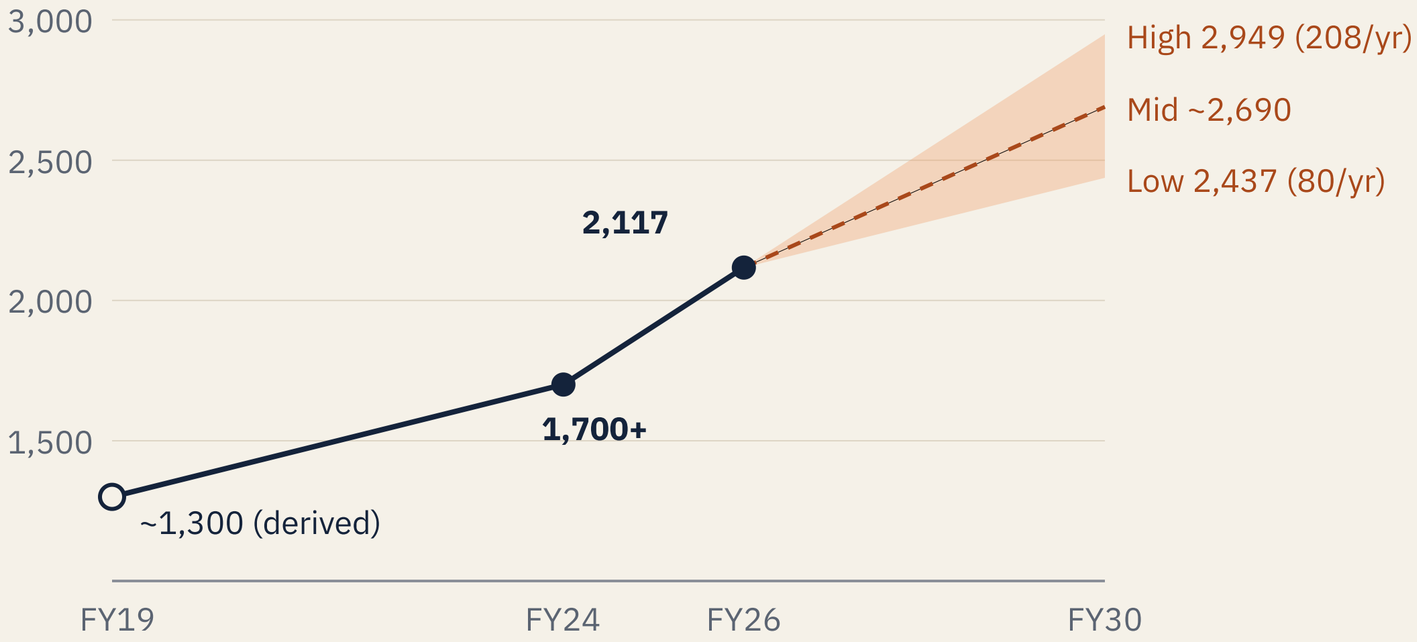
Revenue pool	How many	Price anchor today	Our price
Entrant team tier	110–165 new GCCs a year, plus expansions among 2,117	Aokah subscription (not public); advisory retainers	To set
Data buyers	Brokers, recruiters, investors, 10 policy states	GCC Explorer: $3,500–10,000 a term	To set
Provider evidence hosting	32 firms in Everest's rating, plus mid-size firms	Everest report: $6,499; Clutch and G2 profiles	To set

No total yet, on purpose. The prices should come from 10 to 20 customer conversations in the first 90 days. The $98B is GCC revenue, not this market.

Sources: TeamLease, UnearthIQ, Zinnov–nasscom, CBRE (as cited earlier); GCC Explorer pricing page; Everest Group PEAK Matrix 2025

THE POSITIONING · WHICH GCCS COME NEXT

GCCs in India to FY30: a directional range, not a forecast



The pace: about 80 net additions a year in FY19–24, about 208 a year in FY24–26. The range carries each pace forward.

The caveat: part of the recent jump may be wider counting. The government expects ~2,400 by 2030, near our low end.

Which ones: the prototype's Signals tab gives each possible entrant a likelihood of going live within 12 months, from a logistic score on its filings ladder. Weights are set by judgement, not trained.

A real forecast needs years of clean, dated entries. The Ledger collects exactly that.

One series, companies not centres. Sources: PIB/MeitY citing nasscom (Dec 2025): 1,700+ in FY24, 400+ added in five years; Zinnov–nasscom: 2,117 (Mar 2026).

THE POSITIONING · BUSINESS MODEL

Revenue in this order, and one line we dropped

Revenue line	Who pays	Neutral?	Rule
1. Decision Room team tier	The entrant	Yes	Lead with this. The reference stays free.
2. Pipeline and benchmarks	Brokers, recruiters, states, investors	Yes	Counts and trends only. No contacts, no city scores.
3. Provider evidence hosting	Providers, flat annual fee	Mostly	Verification never tied to payment; payers labelled.
Dropped: paid intros, success fees	Providers, per lead or deal	No	Replaced by free reference calls the entrant asks for.

Guardrail: rankings and evidence levels are computed, never bought. Nobody pays per lead. Entrants never pay to see the facts.

THE POSITIONING · HONEST ASSESSMENT

Pros, cons and limitations

Pros

- An underserved buyer: most GCC data is sold to vendors
- Data that compounds: each setup can add a confirmed receipt
- One decision instead of four tools
- Cheap to run: public data plus AI extraction

Cons

- Entrants decide once: about 40–60 mid-market a year
- The surface (list, planner) is copyable in a quarter
- Any supply-side revenue risks looking biased
- Behind on coverage, freshness and brand today

Limitations

- Open MCA foreign-company data we found runs only to 2023
- Real rents and salaries are private: we show ranges
- Prototype runs on seed data: 52 GCCs, 26 providers
- Salaries, talent pools and cost inputs are our estimates

THE POSITIONING · RISKS

What could go wrong, and how we handle it

Risk	How we handle it
Wrong or stale data	Tiers, as-of dates, conflicts shown, one-click corrections.
AI invents figures	Answers only from the Ledger, cites a record, else says “not in our data”.
An incumbent adds a buyer view	Build first what needs relationships: receipts and the filings pipeline.
Issuer-pays conflict	Flat fees only, published method, verification never tied to payment.
Defamation and NDAs	Record facts confirmed by both sides, not opinions or star ratings.
States as payers	Sell states benchmarks of their own performance only; never city scores.
Personal data (DPDP Act 2023)	Sell no contact details; aggregated data only.
Liability for incentive summaries	Link the notified policy text; label summaries as guidance.

PROTOTYPE AND NEXT STEPS

The prototype shows the differentiators; 90 days test the bet

In prototype v2, in demo order

1. Decision Room: cited board pack, stale flags, guests
2. Delivery receipts with a working confirm form
3. Signals: six real announcements, two labelled illustrative
4. Planner: EOR, BOT or own entity, with fees and timelines
5. Directory with a deep source link on every record
6. Ask the Ledger: answers only from the data, cited

Demo: plan a 300-person BFSI GCC, open the Decision Room, then confirm a delivery receipt.

What we test next

1. Interview 5 people who set up a GCC in the last two years
2. Do 10 to 20 entry leads use the Decision Room for a real board memo?
3. Audit 30 records against filings and publish the error rate
4. Will 10 GCC leaders confirm delivery receipts?
5. Will 3 mid-size providers pay a flat fee with no lead promise?

Prototype v2: claude.ai/artifact/MKq7LE3ToVydrXj2DLjpwq · Planned, not built: per-GCC “counted by” labels, since no report publishes its named list.

Sources

Market

- Zinnov–nasscom, India GCC Landscape FY26
- Zinnov, 5 shifts in India's GCC story (Jan 2026)
- PIB/MeitY on GCCs, citing nasscom (Dec 2025)
- IANS, Lok Sabha reply (Aug 2025)
- Vestian via PTI, city counts (Jul 2025)
- CBRE, state GCC policies, via Entrepreneur (Aug 2026)
- JLL, Haryana GCC policy (2026)
- CRE Matrix, office rents Q1 CY26
- TeamLease via Storyboard18, new GCCs (Nov 2025)
- UnearthIQ via NewsBytes, 2026 greenfield GCCs
- nasscom–Zinnov mid-market report (Apr 2025)

Competitors and setup

- GCC Explorer (AIM Research), pricing and directory
- OceanFrogs, GCC intelligence
- GCC Index, new GCCs in India
- Aokah launch, press release (Apr 2026)
- Draup, location analysis
- Everest Group, GCC setup PEAK Matrix 2025
- Embark GCC calculator (CXOToday)
- SEEPZ SEZ approval minutes (Dec 2024)
- Wisemonk, GCC launch timeline (2026)

Most market figures come via press re-reports. Competitor facts are from their own pages, checked 22 Oct 2026. Severity, scores, verdicts, the matrix, cost figures and timings are our judgement or model output.